

Apache OpenOffice

Version 4.1

Impress Guide

AOO Documentation Team

Chapter 5

Managing Graphic Objects

*Moving, rotating, distorting, and
positioning objects; animations;
Fontwork*

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Note for Mac Users

Some keystrokes and menu items differ on a Mac from those used in Windows and Linux. The table below gives some common substitutions for the instructions in this chapter. For a more detailed list, see the application Help.

<i>Windows/Linux</i>	<i>Mac equivalent</i>	<i>Effect</i>
Tools > Options menu selection	OpenOffice > Preferences	Access setup options
<i>Right-click</i>	<i>Control+click</i>	Open context menu
<i>Ctrl</i> (Control)	⌘ (Command)	Used with other keys
<i>F5</i>	<i>Shift+⌘+F5</i>	Open the Navigator
<i>F11</i>	<i>⌘+T</i>	Open Styles & Formatting window

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Introduction

This chapter describes how to manage graphic objects, specifically how to rotate, distort, arrange, and position them on a slide. Though this chapter focuses on the shapes that can be created with the available tools in Impress, some of the techniques described here are also applicable to images imported into Impress.

The Drawing toolbar contains most of the tools normally used to create graphic objects. If this toolbar is not showing, select **View > Toolbars > Drawing** from the main menu bar.

The toolbar can be divided into two parts. The first part contains drawing objects, as shown in Figure 1. The second part of the toolbar, shown in Figure 3 on page 6, contains more generic tools.

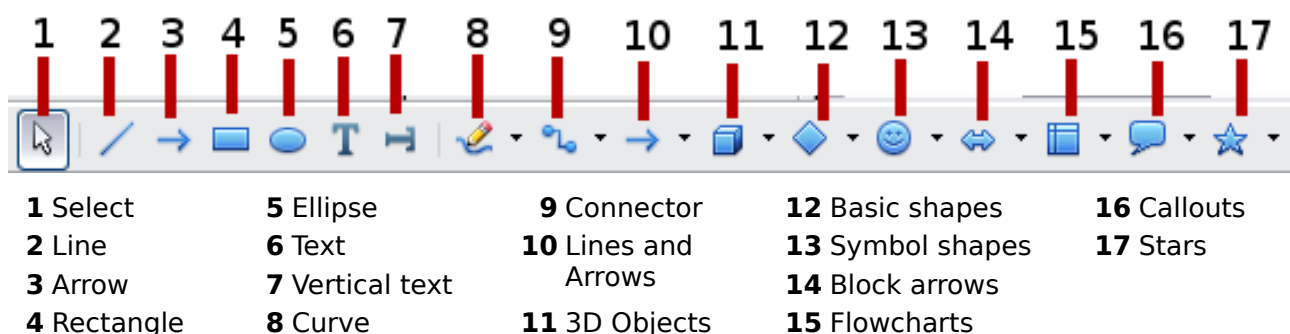
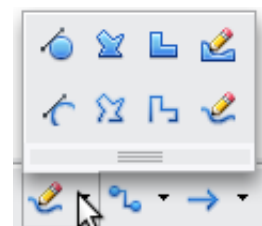


Figure 1: First section of Drawing toolbar

The tools in the first part of the Drawing toolbar are:

- 1) **Select**: selects objects. To select a group of objects, click and drag with the mouse to define a rectangle that contains all of the objects. It is also possible to select several objects by pressing the *Shift* key while selecting individual objects.
- 2) **Line**: draws a straight line from the point where you click the mouse to the point where you release the mouse button after having dragged the mouse pointer. Press the *Shift* key to restrict the angle of the line to multiples of 30°; use the *Control* key to detach the end point of the line from the grid (see “Snapping Objects to Grid or Snap Guides” on page 15).
- 3) **Arrow**: draws a straight line ending with an arrowhead. The arrowhead is placed where you release the mouse button. The *Shift* and *Control* keys have the same effect as they had for the Line tool.
- 4) **Rectangle**: draws a rectangle when you drag the mouse from the top left to the bottom right corner. Press the *Shift* button to draw a square.
- 5) **Ellipse**: draws an ellipse. Press the *Shift* button to draw a circle.
- 6) **Text**: creates a text box with text aligned horizontally.
- 7) **Vertical text**: creates a text box with text aligned vertically. This tool is available only when Asian language support has been enabled in **Tools > Options > Language Settings > Languages**.
- 8) **Curve**: draws a curve. Click the black triangle for more options (shown at right), including polygons. Note that the title of the submenu, when undocked, is *Lines*.



- 9) **Connector**: draws a connector line between two figures. Click the black triangle for additional connectors. Their use is described in “Working with Connectors” on page 17.



- 10) **Lines and Arrows**: draws a line ending in an arrow. Click the black triangle for additional choices. When torn off, this toolbar is titled **Arrows**.



- 11) **Basic Shapes, Symbol Shapes, Block Arrows, Flowcharts, Callouts, Stars**: click the black triangle to open a toolbar showing the available shapes in that category. The default shapes are shown in Figure 2. Select the desired shape, then draw it by dragging the mouse to define an enclosing rectangle. Keep the *Shift* key pressed to obtain a shape where the height and width are equal.

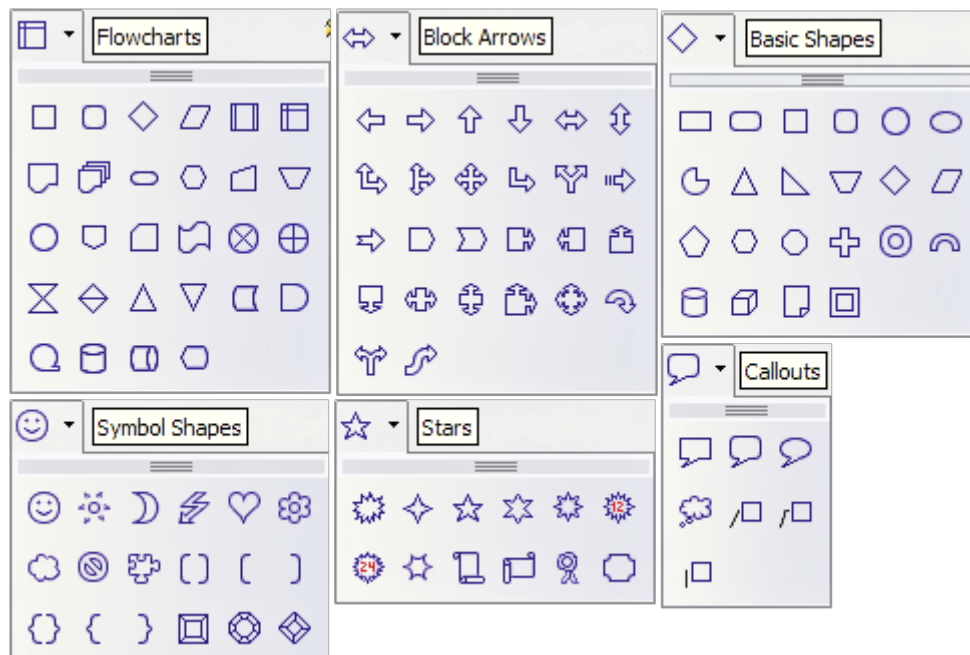


Figure 2: Available shapes for Impress

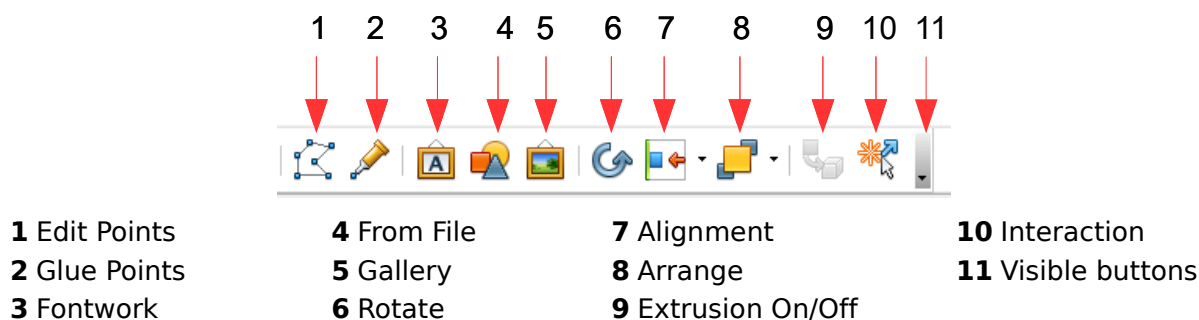


Figure 3: The second section of the drawing toolbar with utility tools

The tools in the second part of the Drawing toolbar are:

- 1) **Edit points:** To edit the individual points that form the shape or line, select this tool, and then select a shape or a line.
- 2) **Glue points:** To edit the glue points of a graphic object, select this tool. Glue points are the positions where connector lines terminate or start. See “Managing Glue Points” on page 18 for instructions.
- 3) **Fontwork:** opens the Fontwork gallery. See “Using Fontwork” on page 24 for further information.
- 4) **From file:** Equivalent to **Insert > Picture > From file** on the main menu. See Chapter 4 for details.
- 5) **Gallery:** opens the gallery. Equivalent to **Tools > Gallery** on the main menu. See Chapter 4 for details.
- 6) **Rotate:** Select this tool to rotate an object. As rotation is considered a formatting attribute. This is discussed in Chapter 6 of this book.
- 7) **Align object:** See “Aligning Shapes” on page 15.
- 8) **Arrange object:** See “Arranging Shapes” on page 17.
- 9) **Extrusion On/Off:** switches 3D effects on or off for the selected object. Clicking this button also opens the 3D settings toolbar. See “Working with 3D Shapes” on page 18 for details.
- 10) **Interaction:** opens a dialog where you can specify the interaction between the user and the object. See “Setting up Interaction with a Shape” on page 21.
- 11) **Visible buttons:** Use the black triangle on the far right of the toolbar to open a menu from which you can add or subtract buttons on the toolbar. See Chapter 1 (Introducing Impress) for more information.

Creating Lines and Shapes

To create shapes and lines:

- 1) Select the desired line or shape tool.
- 2) Click and drag to create the object on the slide.

When drawing a freehand polygon (that is, when you create a shape segment by segment from one of the tools on the Curves toolbar, shown on page 4), keep the *Shift* key pressed to restrict the angle between the segments to multiples of 45 degrees. To finish drawing a polygon, double-click on the last part of the segment. If a closed polygon is selected, Impress

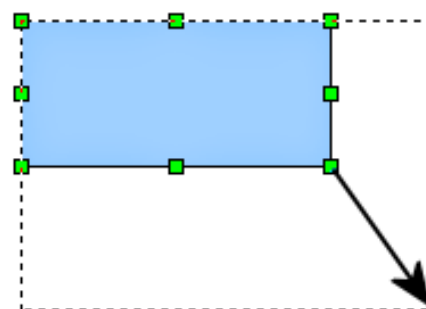


Figure 4: Creating a shape

draws the line connecting the last point to the start point and fills the inside area with the default color.

When drawing certain shapes, one or more yellow dots are displayed along with the green resizing handles. These dots perform a different function depending on the shape to which they are applied. With the basic shapes, the yellow dot (or dots) is used for the following purposes:

- Rounded rectangle and Rounded square shapes: Use the yellow dot to change the size of the curve, replacing the corners.
- Circle Pie: Use the two yellow dots to change the size of the filled sector.
- Isosceles triangle: Move the yellow dot on one vertex to modify the triangle type.
- Trapezoid, Parallelogram, or Octagon: Move the yellow dot to change the angle between the sides.
- Cross: Use the yellow dot to change the thickness of the four sides.
- Ring: Use the yellow dot to change the internal diameter.
- Block arc: Use the yellow dot to change both the internal diameter and the size of the filled area.
- Cylinder and Cube: Use the yellow dot to change the perspective.
- Folded corner: Use the yellow dot to change the size of the corner.
- Frame: Use the yellow dot to change the internal rectangle diagonal.

Grouping Shapes Together

It is often convenient to group shapes together to cause Impress to treat them as a single shape. A group of shapes can be formatted as if it were a single shape, moved, rotated, deleted, and so on. To group shapes together, do as follows:

- 1) Select the shapes to be grouped. To do this, use the selection tool on the drawing toolbar and draw a rectangle around the shapes to be grouped, or click on each shape to be added to the group while pressing the *Shift* key.
- 2) When the green resizing handles show, select **Format > Group > Group** or press *Control+Shift+G* on the keyboard.

Once the group is defined, click on any of the shapes within the group to select it. To edit only the shapes in the group, press *F3* when the group is selected or select **Format > Group > Enter group** from the menu bar. Notice that any shapes not part of the group are grayed out and that only the shapes belonging to the group can be edited. Use this function when you need to apply a particular format to a single member of the group. To exit from group mode, press *Control+F3* or select **Format > Group > Group** from the menu bar.

For more about working with grouped objects, see Chapter 5 (Combining Multiple Objects) in the *Draw Guide*.

To ungroup objects:

- 1) Select the group of shapes.
- 2) When the green resizing handles show, select **Format > Group > Ungroup** from the menu bar.

Tip

If you use the group and ungroup commands often, consider adding them to one of the toolbars shown by default, so that the commands are readily available. To do so, you will need to customize the selected toolbar. See Chapter 11 (Setting Up and Customizing Impress).

Moving Graphic Objects

- 1) Click the graphic object, if necessary, to show the green resizing handles..
- 2) Move the pointer over the graphic object until the pointer changes shape. On most operating systems, the cursor associated with moving objects is a four-headed arrow, but it may also be a hand or another symbol.
- 3) Click and drag the graphic object to the desired position (you can also use the arrow keys).
- 4) Release the mouse button.

Tip

By default, Impress makes objects snap to the grid. To position the object between two points of the grid, hold down the *Control* key, then click on the object and move it to the desired position.

Alternatively, you can modify the grid resolution by going to **Tools > Options > OpenOffice Impress > Grid**.

For a more accurate placement of the graphic object, use the Position and Size dialog box shown in Figure 5. First, select the graphic object by clicking on it; when the resizing green handles are displayed, either press *F4* or select **Format > Position and Size** from the menu bar.

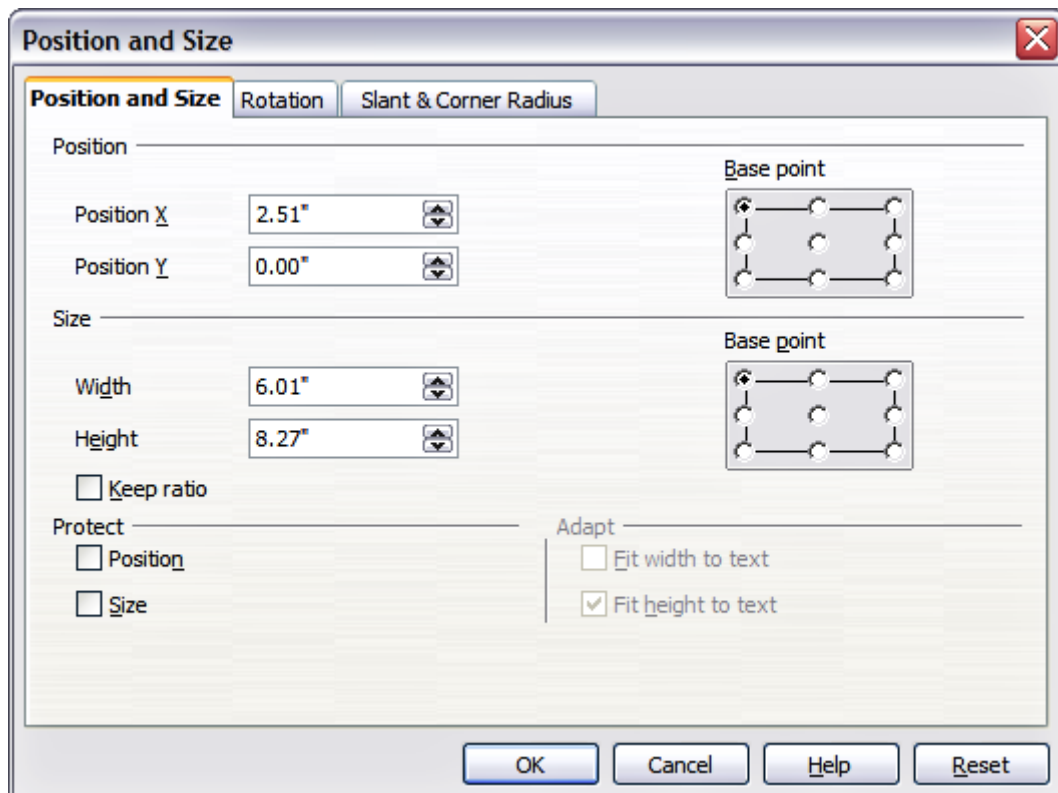


Figure 5: Fine adjustment of position and size of the graphic object

Use the *Position* tab of the dialog to specify the X (horizontal) and Y (vertical) position of the graphic object. The values represent the distance of the base point (selected on the right side of the dialog) relative to the top left corner of the slide.

To prevent accidental modification of the position of the graphic object, select the **Position** option in the *Protect* section (bottom left) of the dialog.

The unit of measurement for this and the other dialog boxes in this section is set in **Tools > Options > OpenOffice Impress > General**.

Resizing Graphic Objects

- 1) Click the graphic object to show the green resizing handles.
- 2) Position the pointer over one of the green resizing handles. The pointer changes shape, giving a graphical representation of the direction of the resizing.
- 3) Click and drag to resize the graphic object.
- 4) Release the mouse button to complete resizing.

The corner handles resize both the width and the height of the graphic object simultaneously, while the other four handles resize only one dimension at a time.

Tip

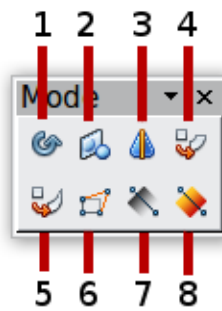
To retain the original proportions of the graphic, *Shift+click* one of the corner handles, then drag. Be sure to release the mouse button **before** releasing the *Shift* key.

For more accurate resizing of the graphic object, use the Position and Size dialog (Figure 5). Select as the base point the part of the graphic object that you would like to anchor to the page. The default setting (top-left corner) means that when resizing, the position of the top left corner of the object will not change. Now modify either the *Width* value or the *Height* value of the object. To maintain proportions between width and height, select the **Keep ratio** option before modifying any value. When **Keep ratio** is selected, changes to one of the dimensions result in automatic changes to the other.

To prevent accidental modifications of the size, make sure that the **Size** option is selected in the *Protect* section in the bottom left part of the dialog.

Applying Special Effects

Besides the basic actions of moving and resizing an object, a number of special effects can also be applied to the objects in Impress. Several of these effects are readily available in the Mode toolbar shown in Figure 6. If the Mode toolbar is not showing, select it from **View > Toolbars > Mode**.



- | | | |
|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------|-----------------------|
| 1 Rotate | 4 Set in Circle (perspective) | 7 Transparency |
| 2 Flip | 5 Set to Circle (slant) | 8 Gradient |
| 3 In 3D Rotation Object | 6 Distort | |

Figure 6: Mode toolbar

This section describes how to rotate, flip, distort, and two ways of setting an object in a circle. The transparency and gradient tools, which are more specific to formatting, are discussed in Chapter 6.

Rotating Graphic Objects

Rotation of an object can be carried out manually or using a dedicated dialog, just like changing the object position and size. To rotate a graphic manually:

- 1) Select the graphic object if necessary so that the green handles show around it.
- 2) Click the **Rotate** button  in the Drawing toolbar or in the Mode toolbar.

Note

The icons representing the functions in the toolbars are different depending on the operating system used. When in doubt, hover the mouse over the icons and wait for the tooltip to appear, showing the name of the button. The tooltip for the sub-toolbar containing the **Rotate** function is *Effects*.

- 3) Eight red handles replace the green square handles, as shown in Figure 7. Move the mouse over one of the corner handles, and the mouse cursor shape will change. Click the mouse and move in the direction in which you want to rotate the graphic object.
- 4) When satisfied, release the mouse button.

At step 2), a black cross hair with a circle appears in the middle of the picture: this represents the pivot point for the rotation. Normally, the center of the picture will be fine, but on some occasions, you may wish to rotate around a corner or even around a point outside the picture; to do that, click on the crosshair and drag it to the desired position.

To restrict the rotation angles to multiples of 15 degrees, press the *Shift* key while rotating the graphic. This is very handy for rotating pictures through a right angle, for example, from portrait to landscape or back.

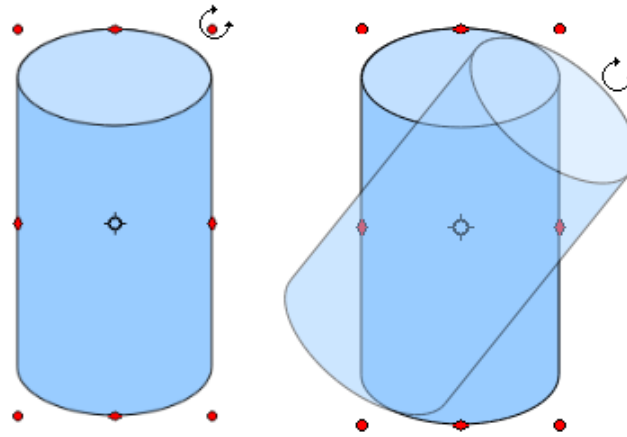


Figure 7: Shape showing the red rotating handles. Only the corner ones are active. The black crosshair indicates the rotation pivot.

Instead of rotating a graphic object manually, you can use the **Rotation** dialog shown in Figure 8. To display this dialog, select the graphic object so that the green resizing handles are shown, then press *F4* or select **Format > Position and Size** and select the **Rotation** tab.

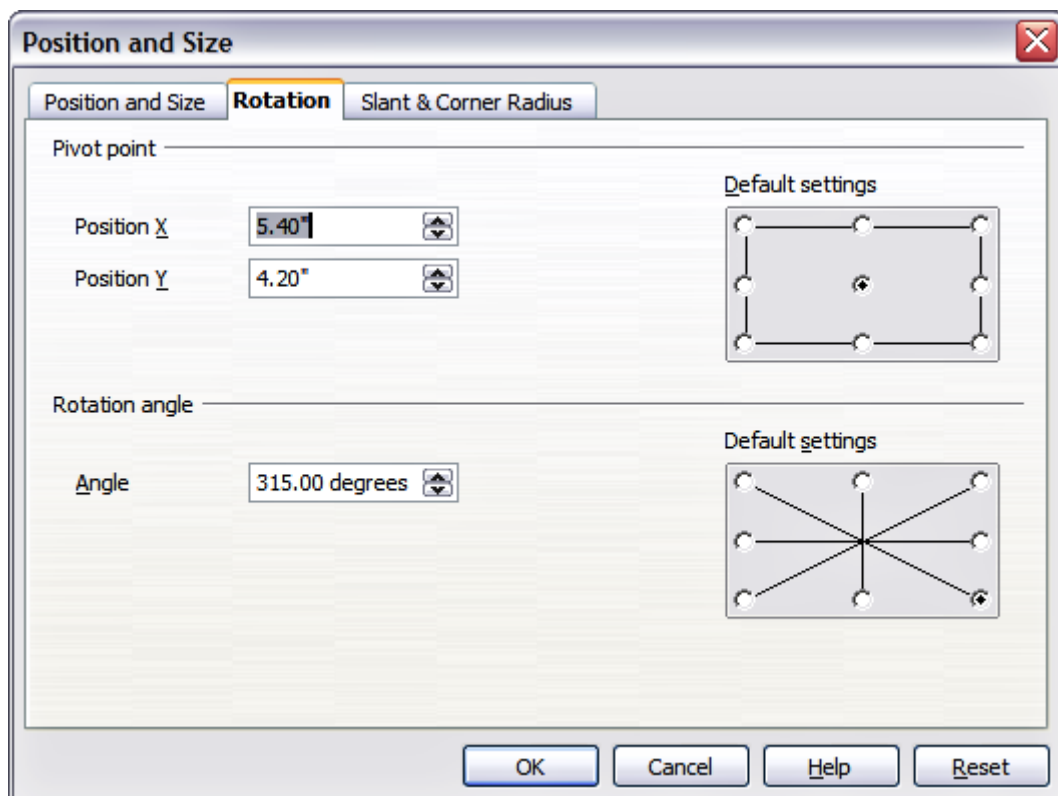


Figure 8: The Rotation page of the Position and Size dialog

In the upper part of the dialog, select the position of the pivot point relative to the top left corner of the page. The default position of the pivot point is the center of the figure.

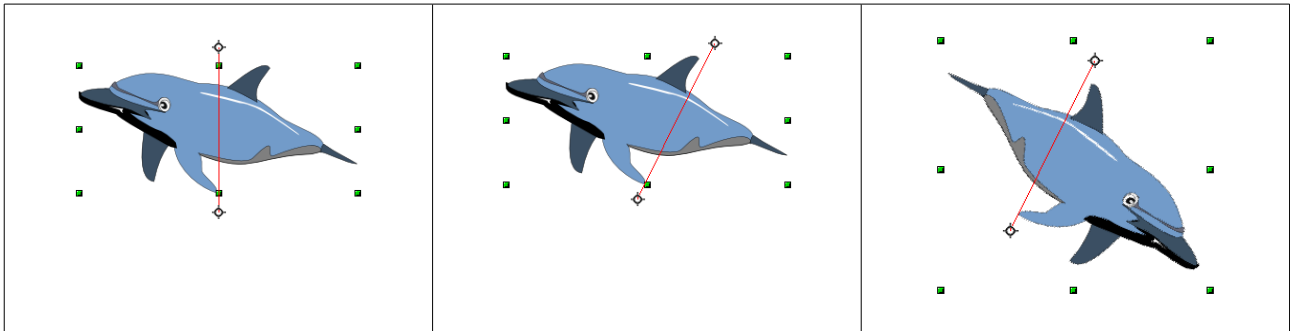
In the lower part of the dialog, select the angle by which to rotate the graphic object. To the right of the Angle text box, 8 default rotation values can be easily selected.

Flip an Object

Select an object and click the **Flip** icon . You will see a dashed line through the middle of the object.

This dashed line is the **axis of symmetry**. The object will be reflected symmetrically around this line. Move one or both ends of the line with your mouse to set the orientation of the axis.

Then, grab any one of the eight green handles and move it across to the other side of the dashed line. The new position of the figure is shown faintly until the mouse is released.



Note If you press the *Shift* key while moving the line, the line will rotate in 45-degree increments.

Mirror Copies

This useful command does not exist in Draw or Impress. It can, however, be easily imitated.

Move the axis of symmetry to the desired location of the mirror axis. Copy the object to the clipboard. Flip the object, then click on an empty area of the page to deselect it. Paste from the clipboard to put a copy of the object in its original location, and now you have a mirror copy.

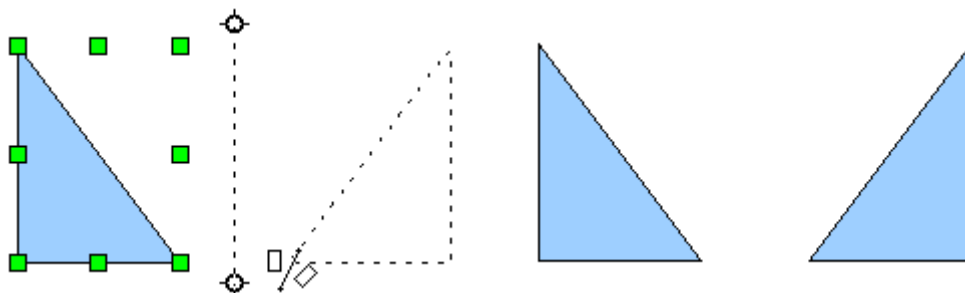


Figure 9: Making a mirror copy of an object

Distorting an Image

Three tools on the Mode toolbar let you drag the corners and edges of an object to distort the image.

The **Distort** tool distorts an object in perspective; the **Set to Circle (slant)** and **Set in Circle (perspective)** tools both create a pseudo three-dimensional effect. In all three cases, you are initially asked if you want to transform the object into a curve. This is a necessary first step, so click **Yes**. Then you can move the object handles to produce the desired effect.

The results of using these tools are shown in the following figures.

Distort an Object

Select an object and click on the **Distort** icon . After converting to a curve as requested, move the handles to stretch the object.

The corner handles distort, as shown in Figure 10. The vertical midpoint handles distort the figure horizontally, and the horizontal ones distort it vertically.

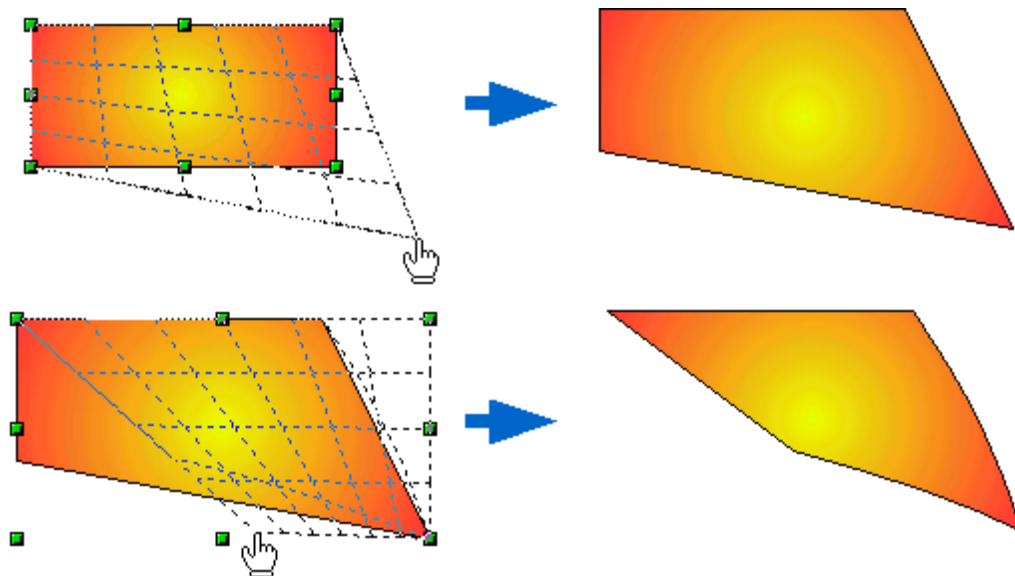


Figure 10: Distort an image

Set in Circle (Perspective)

Select an object and click the **Set in Circle (perspective)**  icon. After converting to a curve, move the object handles to give a pseudo-three-dimensional perspective.

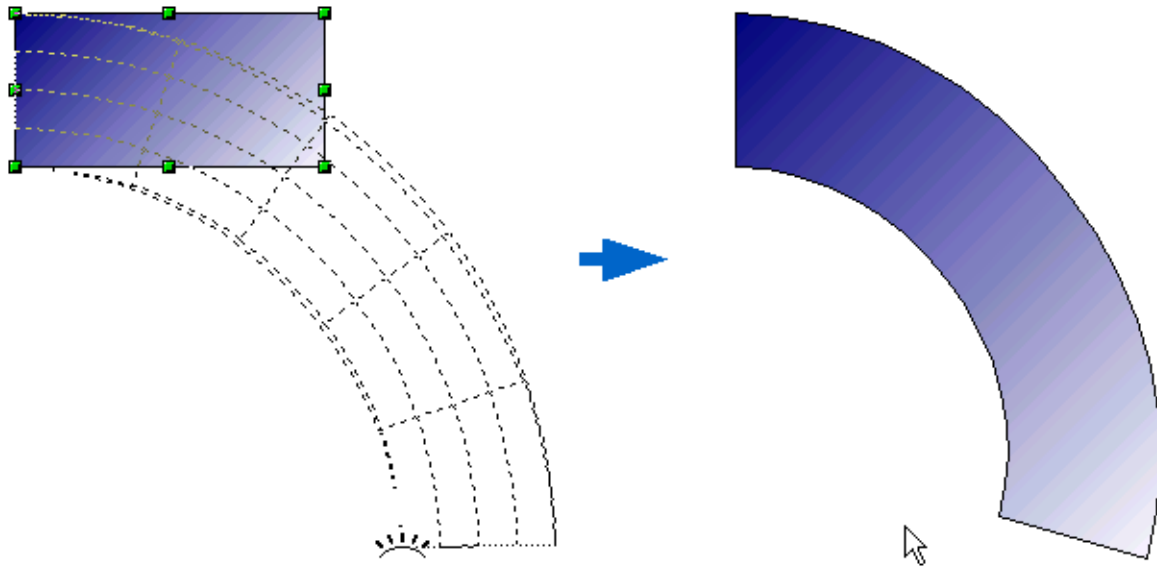


Figure 11: Set an image in a circle with perspective

Set to Circle (Slant)

Select an object and click on the **Set to Circle (slant)**  icon. After converting to a curve, move the object handles to give a pseudo three-dimensional slant perspective.

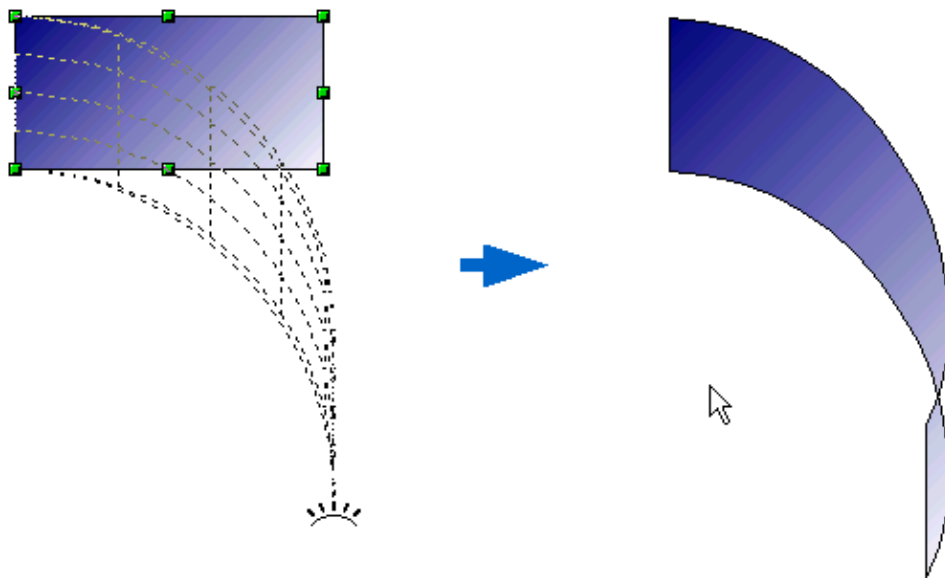


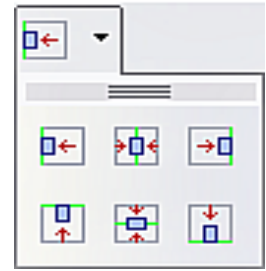
Figure 12: Set an image to a circle with slant perspective

Note Transforming an object into a curve is a safe operation, but it cannot be reversed other than by clicking the **Undo** button.

Aligning Shapes

Use the alignment tools to adjust the relative position of a graphic object compared to another object. Clicking on the arrow beside the Alignment icon in the Drawing toolbar opens the extended toolbar. The same alignment options are available from the right-click menu.

The toolbar has six icons. The first three determine the horizontal alignment of the selected objects (Left, Center, Right); the other three determine the vertical alignment of the selected objects (Top, Middle, Bottom). If only one object is selected, it is aligned to the page; however, when several objects are selected together, single objects are aligned to the border of the group selection.



Snapping Objects to Grid or Snap Guides

Sometimes it is important to align objects to specific points on the page, or to ensure objects that appear on multiple slides are placed in exactly the same position on each such slide. For this purpose, Impress provides two mechanisms: the **Grid** and **Snap Guides** (also known as **Snap Lines**).

Using the Grid

Options for the grid are available in the menu that opens when you right-click on an empty part of the page in Normal view. From this menu, choose **Grid**. Or, select **View > Grid** from the menu bar. In both cases, a submenu with three options opens:

- **Visible Grid**: displays the grid.
- **Snap to Grid**: The anchor points of an object will always be placed on a grid when the object is moved or resized.
- **Grid to Front**: displays the grid in the foreground.

To set up the grid spacing and snapping options, choose **Tools > Options > OpenOffice Impress > Grid** from the menu bar.

Using Snap Guides

Options for the guides are available in the menu that opens when you click on an empty part of the page in Normal view and choose **Snap Lines**, or select **View > Guides** from the menu bar. A submenu with three options opens:

- **Display Guides (Snap Lines Visible)**: The guides are shown on the slide.
- **Snap to Guides (Snap to Snap Lines)**: The anchor points of the objects snap to the guides when the object is moved or resized.
- **Guides to Front (Snap Lines to Front)**: The guides are brought to the foreground and cover the objects.

Note	The main menu uses the term <i>Guides</i> , but the pop-up menu refers to <i>Snap Lines</i> .
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To create a new guide:

- 1) Right-click on an empty part of the work area and select **Insert Snap Point/Line** from the pop-up menu.

- 2) In the dialog that appears, specify the type (Point, Vertical line, or Horizontal line).
- 3) Depending on the choice made, the two edit fields X and Y become active; enter the position of the guide.
- 4) Click **OK** to close the dialog.

Tip When positioning the Snap Guides, it is useful to display the rulers. To do so, select **View > Rulers**.

Tip Drag a Snap Guide directly onto the slide by clicking on the ruler and then dragging it onto the slide.

To edit a guide:

- 1) Right-click next to or on the guide to be edited.
- 2) Select **Edit Snap line** from the pop-up menu.
- 3) Enter the new value (or values) and click **OK**.

To delete a guide:

- 1) Right-click next to or on the guide to be deleted.
- 2) Choose **Delete Snap line** from the pop-up menu.

Figure 13 shows the three types of guides, the grid on a slide, and the dialog to create a new guide.

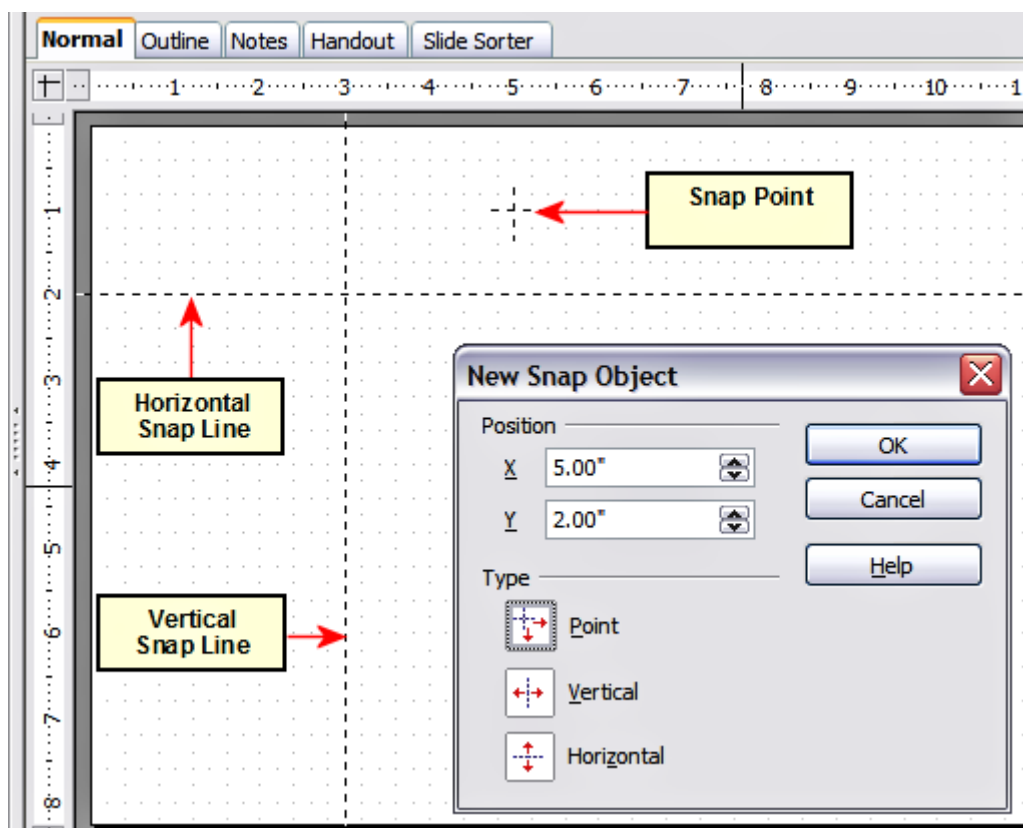


Figure 13: Gridline, snap lines, and snap point on a slide

Arranging Shapes

Arrange determines the stacking order of the selected object. Draw and Impress organize objects in a stack, so that objects on a high level cover objects on lower levels if overlapping occurs. To modify the position of an object in the stack, click the small triangle on the side of the *Arrange* icon to open the extended toolbar. The same arrange options described below are available from the right-click menu.



The first four tools determine the position of the selected object:

- **Bring to front:** the selected object is moved on top of any other object.
- **Bring forward:** the selected object is moved one level up in the stack.
- **Send backwards:** the selected object is moved one level down in the stack.
- **Send to back:** the selected object is given the lowest position in the stack.

The other three tools determine the relative positions of the selected object and of a second selected object:

- **In front of object:** brings the first selected object in front of the second selected object.
- **Behind object:** brings the first selected object behind the second selected object.
- **Reverse:** swaps the stacking order of two selected objects.

To use the **In front of object** and **Behind object** tools:

- 1) Select the first object by clicking on it.
- 2) When the green handles show, select the desired arrange action.
- 3) The mouse pointer changes to a pointing hand. Click on the second object.

Working with Connectors

Connectors are lines that can be anchored to particular places, called *glue points*, on the graphic object. The advantage of connectors is that when the graphic to which the connector is attached is moved or resized, the connector automatically adjusts to the change. When creating a flowchart, org chart, schematic, or diagram, connectors are highly recommended instead of simple lines.

Impress offers a wide variety of predefined connectors, which differ in the termination shape (none, arrow, custom) and in the way the connector is drawn (straight, line, curved).

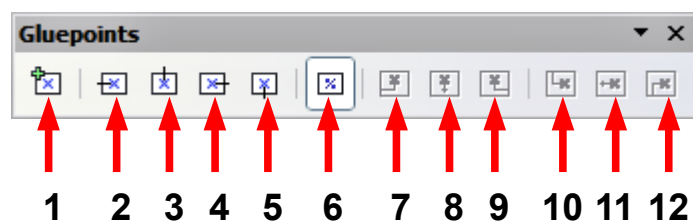
When a connector is drawn or selected, Impress displays red handles, which are not shown for normal lines. In particular, termination points are identified by red circles, while square handles are used to modify the routing of a connector (where applicable).

Draw a connector in a similar way to drawing any object. First, select the connector style from the Connector toolbar, then move the mouse cursor over one of the objects to be connected. When the cursor is over the object, small black crosses appear around it; these represent the glue points to which the connector can be attached. Click on the required glue point to attach one end of the connector, then hold the mouse button down and drag the connector to the second object. When the cursor is over the glue point of the target object, release the mouse button.

For instructions on how to format a connector, refer to the corresponding section in Chapter 6 (Formatting Graphic Objects).

Managing Glue Points

As described above, a glue point is the point of attachment for a connector to a shape or graphic object. Each shape has several predefined glue points, but it is possible to define new ones and edit existing ones, using the **Gluepoints toolbar** shown in Figure 14.



- | | | | |
|----------------|---------------|---------------------|-------------------|
| 1 Insert point | 4 Exit right | 7 Horizontal left | 10 Vertical left |
| 2 Exit left | 5 Exit bottom | 8 Horizontal center | 11 Vertical top |
| 3 Exit top | 6 Relative | 9 Horizontal right | 12 Vertical right |

Figure 14: The Gluepoints toolbar

Use the first tool to insert a new glue point. The next four tools determine the exit direction of the connector terminating at the glue point. To maintain the relative position of the glue point when resizing the object, make sure that the **Glue point relative** icon (highlighted in Figure 14) is selected. Deselecting the **Glue point relative** icon activates the remaining six icons on the toolbar; use these to fix the position of the glue point during the resizing of the object. Hover the mouse over the buttons to display a tooltip giving a brief description of its function.

To delete a custom glue point, select it with the mouse and press the *Delete* key.

Setting custom glue points is particularly useful when multiple connectors terminate on the same side of a shape, or when the default glue point position is unsatisfactory.

To move a predefined or newly inserted glue point:

- 1) Select the glue point tool from the drawing toolbar (see Figure 3).
- 2) Click on the glue point you want to move. The glue point should now be highlighted.
- 3) Keep the mouse button pressed and drag the glue point to the desired position. Release the mouse button.

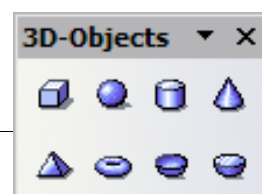
Tip

Glue points are placed by default on the grid (see “Snapping Objects to Grid or Snap Guides” on page 15 for information). But sometimes it's necessary to fine-tune the position of a glue point depending on its shape. To do this, keep the *Control* key pressed while dragging the glue point to the new position.

Working with 3D Shapes

3D graphic objects can be created in different ways in Impress:

- From the 3D-Objects toolbar. The 3D-Objects tool is not included in the default Drawing toolbar. To include it, click



on the small triangle at the end of the toolbar, select **Visible Buttons**, and select **3D-Objects** from the list. On the Drawing toolbar, click on the triangle by the 3D-Objects icon to display the extended 3D Objects toolbar.

- From the **Convert** sub-menu. Select a shape, right-click on it, and in the Convert sub menu choose either **To 3D** to add thickness to the object or **To 3D Rotation Object** to create a 3D shape resulting from the rotation of the object around an axis.
- From the **Extrusion on/off** icon on the drawing toolbar. Select the shape to which to apply a 3D effect, then click the  button on the Drawing toolbar (see Figure 15).

Caution



You can not apply extrusion to rectangular and oval shapes created by using the rectangle or oval tools. Instead, select the desired shape from the basic shapes menu to create a rectangle or oval with 3D effects. Alternatively, right-click on the object, then select **Convert > To 3D**. Note that in this case, the **Extrusion on/off** menu will not be enabled.

Although Impress offers advanced functions to manipulate 3D objects, this book describes only the 3D settings applicable to an object with Extrusion enabled. For additional information on using advanced 3D effects such as geometry and shading, refer to the *Draw Guide*.

Click on  to activate the extrusion. The shape changes, and a default thickness is added to it. At the same time, the 3D-Settings toolbar should become visible. If the toolbar does not appear, select **View > Toolbars > 3D-Settings**.



Figure 15: The 3D-Settings toolbar

Use the tools to change the appearance of the 3D object.



Extrusion On/Off: adds thickness to an object and activates the 3D properties.



Tilt Down: tilts the object downwards around a horizontal axis.



Tilt Up: tilts the object up around a horizontal axis.



Tilt Left: tilts the object left around a vertical axis.



Tilt Right: tilts the object right around a vertical axis.



Depth: determines the thickness of the shape. An extended toolbar opens, displaying some default values. If none of them is satisfactory, select Calculate and then enter the desired thickness.



Direction: opens an extended toolbar that lets you pick the direction of the perspective as well as the type (parallel or perspective)..



Lighting: opens an extended toolbar that lets you specify the direction and intensity of light.



Surface: Choose between Wire frame (useful when manipulating the object), Matt, Plastic, or Metal.



3D Color: Select the color of the object's thickness.

Most of the Fontwork shapes (see “Using Fontwork” on page 24) have 3D properties and can be manipulated with the 3D-Settings toolbar.

Note that when rotating a 3D object, in addition to the corner red handles, four handles on the sides of the frame become available.

Figure 16 is an example of a customized 3D object.

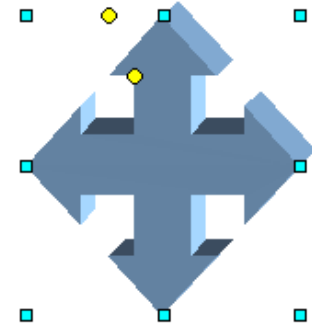


Figure 16: Example of 3D object

Converting an Object to a Different Type

You can convert an object into a different type. Right-click on the object and select **Convert** to display a menu containing the following options:

- **To Curve:** converts the selected object to a Bézier curve. Choose Edit Points to edit the Bézier curve.

Note

Bézier curves are widely used in [computer graphics](#). Such curves are composed of control points that define a smooth, continuous curve, described by a formula. Usually, the curve is intended to approximate a real-world shape that otherwise has no mathematical representation. Recent uses include computer [fonts](#) and animation.

- **To Polygon:** converts the selected object to a polygon. After the conversion, choose Edit Points to edit the shape. A polygon always consists of straight segments.
- **To Contour:** For basic shapes, this is equivalent to converting to a polygon. For more complex shapes (or for text objects) this conversion creates a group of polygons that you can then manipulate by pressing *F3* to enter the group.
- **Convert to 3D:** converts the selected object to a three-dimensional (3D) object.
- **Convert to 3D Rotation Object:** creates a three-dimensional shape by rotating the selected object around its vertical axis.
- **To Bitmap:** converts the selected object to a bitmap.
- **To metafile:** converts the selected object to Windows Metafile Format (WMF), containing both bitmap and vector graphic data.

Note In most cases, the conversion to a different type does not produce immediately visible results.

Setting up Interaction with a Shape

You can associate a shape or an image with some action to be performed when the user clicks on it. To create an interaction:

- 1) Select the graphic object for which an interaction will be created.
- 2) When the green handles appear, select from the Drawing toolbar (Figure 3) the

Interaction button  or right-click on the object and select **Interaction** from the pop-up menu.

- 3) The dialog shown in Figure 17 is displayed. Select the interaction type and the parameters (if applicable). Click **OK** to close the dialog.

To remove an interaction from a graphic object, follow steps 1–3 above, taking care to select **No action** as the interaction type at step 2.

The possible actions and their parameters are described in Table 1.

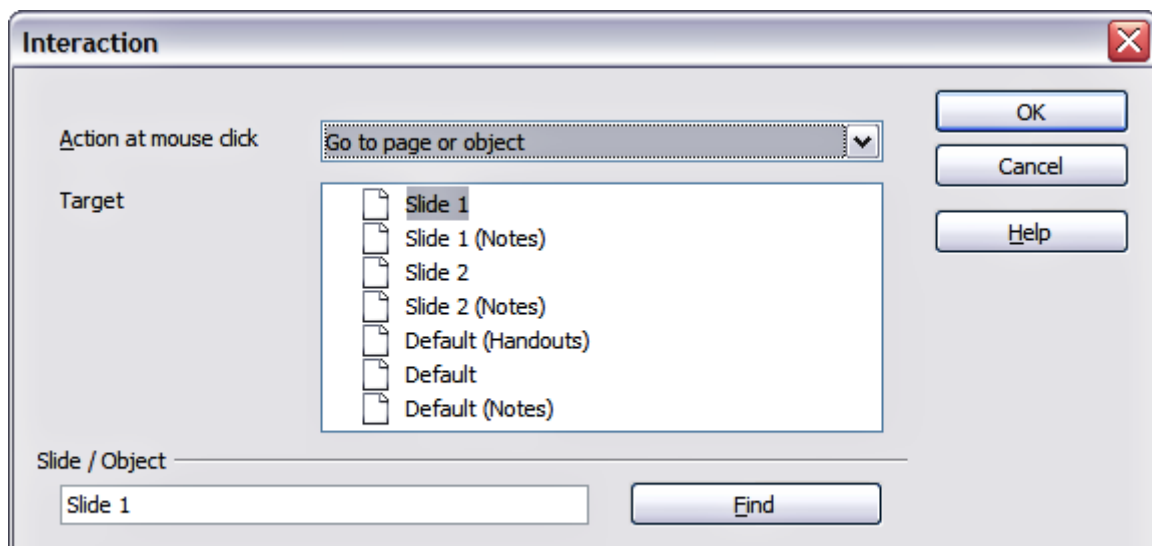


Figure 17: dialog to set the interaction with a graphic object

Table 1: Interactions and their parameters

Interaction type	Parameters
Go to Previous slide	No parameters.
Go to Next slide	No parameters.
Go to First slide	No parameters.
Go to Last slide	No parameters.
Go to Page or Object	Specify the target from the list in the Target box. You can search for a specific target in the Document box at the bottom of the screen.

Interaction type	Parameters
Go to Document	Select the document in the Document box. Use the Browse button to open a file picker dialog. If the document to be opened is in Open Document Presentation format, the target list will be populated, allowing the selection of the specific target in the document.
Play sound	Select the file containing the sound to be played. Use the Browse button to open a file picker dialog.
Run program	Select the program to execute. Use the Browse button to locate it.
Run Macro	Select a macro that will run during the presentation. Use the Browse button to open the macro browser dialog.
Exit presentation	When the mouse is clicked over the graphic object, the presentation will terminate.

Animating Images

An animated image consists of a sequence of images (frames) that are displayed in succession. Each frame may contain one or multiple drawing objects. To start creating a custom animated image, open the Animation dialog from **Insert > Animated Image** (Figure 18).

Creating an Animation

Several mechanisms can be used to create an animated image. This chapter describes only two of them, which should be sufficient to understand the functions offered.

Frame-by-Frame Animation

- 1) Create the image you intend to animate using the drawing tools shown in Figure 18
- 2) Select the image and click the **Apply Object**  button. This copies the object (or objects) into the upper part of the Animation dialog.
- 3) Apply some desired transformation to the object: for example, rotate it or change the color; if you are animating text, add or subtract a letter, and so on.
- 4) When you are ready, create the second frame of the animation and click the **Apply Object** button again.
- 5) Repeat steps 3 and 4 until you have created all the desired frames of the animation.

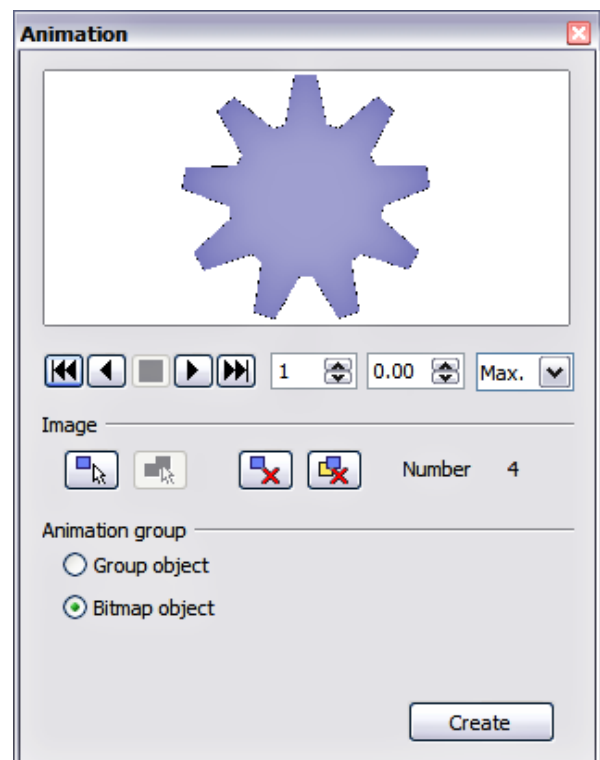


Figure 18: The Animation dialog

- 6) Select **Bitmap object** in the *Animation group* section of the Animator dialog. This allows you to customize the timing of each frame and the number of repetitions for the animation (set the value to *Max* to obtain an infinite loop).
- 7) Click **Create** to place the animated image on the slide.

Note

If the image to be copied in the Animator consists of several objects, you can choose to treat each object as a separate frame. In this case, click the **Apply objects individually** button . Remember that each object will be centered in the animation.

Animated Image in One Step

For some simple animations, it is possible to create all the animation frames in advance and place them on the slide. This method works well for a rotating line, a shape gradually changing color, or shapes increasing or decreasing in size. In most cases, it is convenient to use the **Edit > Duplicate** command.

When all the frames are already prepared, use the **Apply objects individually**  to create one frame for each object.

It is easy to obtain, for example, a rotating line segment:

- 1) Draw a fairly thick horizontal segment (use **Format > Line** or the Line and Filling toolbar to add thickness).
- 2) Open the Duplicate dialog by selecting **Edit > Duplicate** and set the number of copies to 5, the X and Y axis to 0.1, the angle to 30, the enlargement width and height to 0, and press the **OK** button.
- 3) Select the 6 segments created by *Impress* and open the Animator (**Insert > Animated image** from the main menu bar).
- 4) In the Animator dialog, click **Apply objects individually**.
- 5) Select **Bitmap object** in the lower part of the dialog,
- 6) Create a new empty slide to contain your animation, then click the **Create** button.

Other functions of the Animator

You can review the animation at any time by clicking the **Play** button  as well as navigate the various frames using the other controls available.

If you are not satisfied with a particular frame, you can remove it. To do so:

- 1) Navigate to the frame by using the Image Number box with the spin buttons (just to the right of the play controls).
- 2) Click the **Delete current image** button .

You can also delete the entire animation by clicking the **Delete all images** button .

Tip

If you want to work on the animation frames a bit more, you can copy them into the Impress work area by selecting **Group object** and then clicking **Create**.

Tip

Since all the objects are centered in the animation window, to animate an object off the center of the image, create a blank rectangle of the same size of the final image and select it along with the object to be animated. Make sure that **Group object** is selected before clicking the **Apply object** button.

Using Fontwork

Use Fontwork to obtain special text effects. For more about this topic, see Chapter 11 (Graphics, the Gallery, and Fontwork) in the *Getting Started* guide.

To start using Fontwork:

- 1) Open the Fontwork Gallery by clicking the  icon on the Drawing toolbar (see Figure 3) or on the Fontwork toolbar (see Figure 21). If the Drawing toolbar is not showing, you can go directly to the Fontwork toolbar by selecting **View > Toolbars > Fontwork** from the main menu bar.
- 2) Select the preferred style from the Fontwork Gallery (Figure 19) and click **OK**. You can modify it later, so pick one that provides an effect similar to the desired one. The text *Fontwork* in the selected style appears on the slide.



Figure 19: The Fontwork gallery

- 3) Double-click the object to edit the Fontwork text. Type your own text in place of the black *Fontwork* that appears over the object (Figure 20).
- 4) Press the *Esc* key or click outside the area with the green resizing handles to exit.

Now that the Fontwork object is created, you can edit some of its attributes. To do this, you can use the Fontwork toolbar or other options as described in the next section.



Figure 20. Editing Fontwork text

Using the Fontwork Toolbar

Make sure that the Fontwork toolbar, shown in Figure 21, is visible in the workspace. If not, select **View > Toolbars > Fontwork** from the main menu bar.

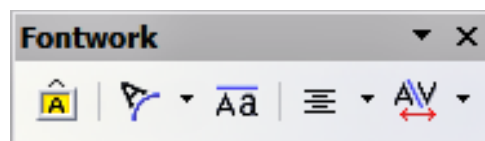
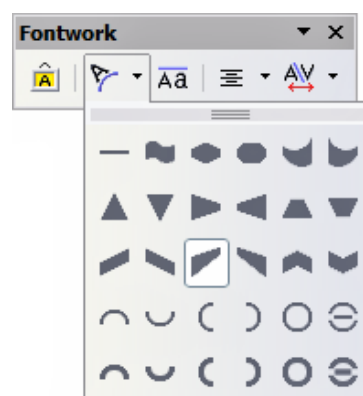


Figure 21: The Fontwork toolbar

In addition to the Fontwork Gallery icon, this toolbar contains the following icons:



Fontwork shape: to change the shape of the selected object, choose a shape from the extended toolbar.



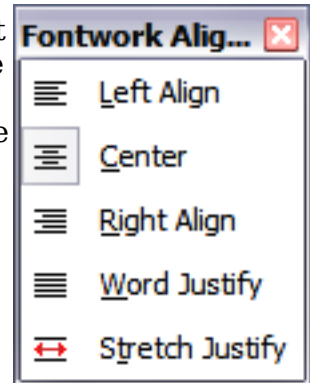
Fontwork Same Letter Heights: Changes the height of characters in the way shown in Figure 22. Toggles between normal height (some characters taller than others, for example, capital letters, d, h, l, and others) and all letters the same height.



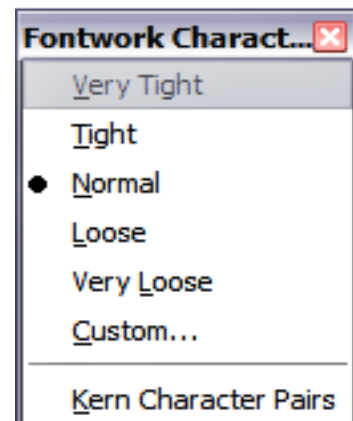
Figure 22. Left: normal letters; right: same letter heights



Fontwork Alignment: Specify the alignment of the text within the frame from the choices available. The effects of the text alignment can only be appreciated if the text spans over two or more lines. In the Stretch Justify mode, all the lines are filled completely.



Fontwork Character Spacing: select the desired spacing and whether kerning pairs should be used. For custom spacing, input a percentage value: 100% is normal spacing; less than 100% is tight spacing; more than 100% is expanded spacing.



Modifying Fontwork Text as a Shape

It is possible to treat Fontwork text as a shape and therefore apply to it all the formatting that has been described in this chapter. Assign line properties only to Fontwork, which does not have a 3D effect; otherwise, the changes will not be visible.

Tip

Change the Fontwork color quickly using the Area fill color swatch on the Line and Filling toolbar.

You can modify some of the Fontwork shapes just as you modify the angles of Trapezoids and Parallelograms by moving the yellow dot displayed along with the green resizing handles.